

TradingAI Complete Workflow and User Guide

Current operator guide for a first-time user.

System reference date: 2026-08-29

Standalone current-state reference for the complete platform through Milestone 78.

1. What TradingAI is

TradingAI is an underlying-first, institutional-style options research, decision, paper-execution and portfolio-management platform. It is not a single scanner and it does not treat one model score as a trade instruction. The system is a chain of governed authorities: each downstream action depends on current upstream evidence, lineage, freshness and risk state.

A new user should think in the sequence **market context -> underlying setup -> option expression -> institutional decision -> portfolio fit -> trade plan -> execution -> position management -> learning**.

2. The current 11-authority mental model

- 1. Data authority - Current normalized underlying, options, futures, event and broker observations.
- 2. Market authority - Market Overview/Market Intelligence: breadth, health, regime, sentiment, sectors, dealer, volatility and cross-asset context.
- 3. Trend authority - Current daily/weekly/monthly trend state, transitions and forecasts.
- 4. Stock authority - Current Stock Intelligence candidate/thesis/structure authority.
- 5. Setup authority - M78 shadow - Explicit setup archetype/lifecycle and research probability/EV evidence. Shadow only; not a production trade authority.
- 6. Options/valuation authority - Exact option strategy/contract identity, liquidity, Greeks, fair value and relative-value evidence.
- 7. Decision authority - Institutional accept/reject/warning reasoning.
- 8. Portfolio authority - Current portfolio risk, fit, capital allocation and ranking.
- 9. Trade-plan authority - Concrete exact-leg entry/stop/target/management plan with revalidation/certification.
- 10. Execution authority - Fresh executable quote/preflight, canonical order intent and broker-rule validation.
- 11. Broker/position authority - IBKR order/fill/account truth reconciled into PostgreSQL and autonomous management.

3. Market Overview - start here

Use Market Overview to understand whether the environment is trending/choppy, risk-on/risk-off, broad/narrow, liquid/illiquid and supportive/hostile for the type of trade under consideration.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Is the market regime compatible with the intended direction and strategy?
- Is breadth confirming or diverging?
- Are sector, dealer, volatility or cross-asset conditions unusually hostile?

4. Daily Scanner - discovery

Use the Daily Scanner to narrow the universe. A high rank is a research priority, not permission to trade.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Is the scanner run current?
- Why is the candidate ranked here?
- Are warnings or missing authorities present?

5. Stock Scanner / Stock Intelligence - underlying thesis

Inspect 1D/1W/1M trend, structural levels/zones, breakout/failure evidence, probability/confidence and contradictory evidence. Identify where the underlying thesis becomes invalid.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Do the three timeframes support the thesis?
- Where are structural support/resistance and invalidation levels?
- Is the candidate's probability/confidence supported by enough evidence?

6. M78 Setup Intelligence - research context

M78 classifies the current Stock Intelligence candidate into explicit setup archetypes and tracks lifecycle state. Today it is shadow-only. Use it to understand what setup the system believes it is observing and to accumulate evidence, not to bypass production Decision Intelligence.

Questions to answer before moving on

- What setup type/stage is detected?
- Is M78 evidence READY or still INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE?
- Is there an active shadow model? If not, do not infer a probability that does not exist.

7. Institutional Options - choose the expression

Review strategies generated from the current underlying thesis. Compare exact expiry/strike/right, DTE, Greeks, liquidity, expected move and strategy economics.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Are the exact contracts liquid enough?
- Does DTE/strike geometry match the thesis and expected holding period?
- Is max loss/reward coherent?

8. Options Mispricing / Valuation - price the structure

Determine whether the option package is attractive relative to independent fair value, volatility surface, event context, dealer context and relative-value comparisons.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Is independent fair value favorable?
- Which valuation components are actually contributing edge?
- Is one weak or stale component dominating the conclusion?

9. Inflection Analytics - timing

Use inflection intelligence to distinguish a good medium-term thesis from poor immediate timing.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Is timing supportive, neutral or contradictory?
- Would waiting for structural confirmation materially improve the entry?

10. Institutional Intelligence / Decision - governed accept/reject

Read the integrated explanation. Supportive and contradictory evidence should be explicit. A rejected or stale decision is not an invitation to override the system.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Is decision authority current?
- What evidence drove acceptance/rejection?
- Are there governance or contradiction findings?

11. Portfolio Intelligence - determine fit and capital

Verify the trade fits the current portfolio. Review exposure, Greeks, heat, concentration, correlation, capital usage and candidate opportunity cost.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Is current portfolio allocation READY?
- Does the trade increase unwanted concentration or directional exposure?
- What capital is actually available and what candidate ranks ahead of it?

12. Advanced Trade Builder - make the plan executable

Turn the approved opportunity into an exact plan. Verify all legs, quantities, entry, stop, targets, management and forced expiration exit.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Are symbol/expiry/strike/right/multiplier correct for every leg?
- Are stop/target/invalidation rules explicit?
- Did strategy-aware and portfolio-aware revalidation pass?

13. Execution Workspace - submit only when executable

Execution preflight uses fresh market data and broker rules. A BLOCK means conditions no longer justify the current execution attempt.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Are quotes fresh?
- Has price drifted outside the governed envelope?
- Does preflight say EXECUTE or BLOCK?

14. Working-order and broker-truth lifecycle

After submission the platform tracks the order, reprices only within governed limits, cancels on hard timeout, reconciles broker terminal state and can create a controlled retry when policy allows. IBKR truth wins for actual fill/cancel state.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Is the order still working, filled or terminally cancelled?
- Has the reprice/envelope budget been consumed?
- Has local state reconciled to broker truth?

15. Position management

Once filled, the position is reconciled into managed state. Autonomous exits can use stop, target, structural, time and risk conditions. Long options and multi-leg structures are closed before expiration under the enforced expiration guardrail.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Is autonomous management active and healthy?
- What is the earliest leg expiration?
- Are stop/target/structural conditions still valid?

16. Performance Learning

After closure, compare what the platform predicted with what happened. Separate thesis, pricing, execution and management contributions.

Questions to answer before moving on

- Was probability calibrated?
- Was P&L driven by thesis, valuation, execution or management?
- Does the evidence justify a governed research proposal rather than an ad-hoc rule change?

17. Daily operating workflow

- Confirm PostgreSQL, API/UI and expected LaunchAgents/services are healthy.
- Allow weekday scheduled ingestion to refresh market, event, underlying and options authorities.
- Start analysis with Market Overview, then move to Daily Scanner and Stock Intelligence.
- Use M78 Setup Intelligence only as shadow research context; do not substitute it for production Decision Intelligence.
- Review Institutional Options, valuation and inflection evidence.
- Require a current institutional decision and current portfolio-aware allocation.
- Build the exact trade plan, revalidate and certify it.
- Execute only after fresh preflight passes.
- Watch working-order lifecycle until fill/cancel terminal state is reconciled.
- Verify autonomous management for every fill and review expiration horizon.
- After closure, use Performance Learning and research evidence rather than intuition to propose future changes.

18. M77/M78 nightly research workflow

The combined research LaunchAgent runs Monday-Friday at 18:30. It first executes the existing M77 forward-shadow program. Research waits/defer safely if the production pipeline is active. M78 runs only after M77 emits an explicit READY marker. M78 then captures current setups, materializes any matured outcomes and scores predictions only when a shadow model has been explicitly approved and activated.

If M78 status says INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE, do not run or force training. That state means the required setup/outcome/date gates have not yet matured.

19. Safe first-use exercise

- Use the paper environment only.
- Pick one current scanner candidate and trace it through Market Overview -> Stock Intelligence -> Institutional Options -> Decision -> Portfolio -> Trade Builder without submitting.
- Explain the exact option legs, maximum risk, structural invalidation and portfolio impact.
- Run execution preflight and explain every freshness/broker-rule result.
- Only after you can explain the full authority chain should you place a small IBKR Paper order.
- Verify the fill appears in broker truth, PostgreSQL state and autonomous management.
- Close/review the position and trace its outcome into Performance Learning.

20. Common operator problems

Symptom	Correct response
STALE / MISSING authority	Repair/regenerate the upstream current publication; do not manually substitute a legacy row.
No portfolio-aware decision	Repair current risk/decision/allocation coverage for the exact Stock Intelligence authority.
Quote stale / adverse drift	Refresh executable quotes and rerun revalidation/preflight.
Contract validation inconclusive	Verify exact symbol, expiry, strike, right, multiplier and broker contract identity.
Cancel appears stuck	Inspect IBKR truth and reconciliation state before creating any duplicate order.
Autonomous exits missing	Verify management service/LaunchAgent, managed-position state and health before relying on automation.
Research looks promising	Keep it under frozen historical/prospective protocol; do not change production thresholds automatically.
M78 train fails INSUFFICIENT_EVIDENCE	Expected governance behavior; wait for more matured outcomes/dates.